PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
ENROLLMENT & TRANSFER CENTER
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Date: March 25, 2025

To: School Board

From: Deborah Giles, Interim Chief Technology Officer
Judy Brennan, Director, Enrollment and Transfer

Subject: 2025-26 Inter-District Transfers

BACKGROUND

Oregon School Boards are required by law to determine annually the standard inter-district transfers procedures for their districts. This memo summarizes the outcomes of the 2024-25 standard interdistrict transfer process and provides information about Right to Return and emergency/hardship transfers, for context.

For the 2025-26 school year, staff recommends a continuation of the following standard inter-district transfer procedures:

1. An unlimited number of non-resident students currently attending PPS schools will be allowed to return to the same schools next year, or to change to a different PPS schools where space is available.
2. An unlimited number of non-resident applicants who have siblings currently attending PPS schools will be allowed to enroll in PPS, if space is available at their requested schools.
3. Up to 100 additional students will be allowed to enroll in PPS, so long as space is available at their requested schools.
4. An unlimited number of students will be released to remain in the districts they are currently attending, if they moved into the PPS district within the past twelve months..
5. An unlimited number of PPS resident students will be released to other districts where their siblings are currently enrolled.

In addition to these standard interdistrict procedures, PPS will continue the Right to Return transfer partnership which was launched in 2023. Right to Return offers students who live in David Douglas, Parkrose and Reynolds school districts a simplified transfer process into most North/Northeast Portland Public schools, in recognition of the generational harmful effects of urban renewal and gentrification.

RELATED POLICIES/BEST PRACTICES

PPS 4.10.040-P, Inter-District Transfers

ANALYSIS OF SITUATION

Overview

The rate of PPS students who live in other districts has increased slightly over the past ten years, from 2.4% to 3.3%. Most students who attend PPS schools while living in other districts started as resident students and then moved out of the PPS boundary. Inter-district transfers are an important tool for providing educational continuity for such students, as well as others seeking specialized programs not available in their home districts.

Table 1: District and Non-resident enrollment comparison: 2014-15 and 2024-25 school years

	2014-15	2024-25	Change
PPS students who reside in other districts	**1,169**	**1,466**	**+297**
Total enrollment	**48,469**	**44,359**	**-4,110**
Percentage of all students	**2.4%**	**3.3%**	**+.9%**

Source: PPS Research, Assessment & Accountability, March, 2024

Students who attend PPS schools and live in other districts are more racially and ethnically diverse than the overall PPS population, as shown in the table below. Furthermore, 49% of PPS students who live in other districts qualify for free meals through direct certification, versus 32% of the overall district population. The rate of Emerging Bilingual (ELL) students who live in other districts and attend PPS schools is 18%, twice the district average of 9%.

Table 2: Race/Ethnicity of PPS students living in other districts, compared to district averages

	Asian	Black	Latino	Multiple - Other	Multiple - Asian/ White	Native American	Pacific Islander	White
District Average (44,359)	6%	8%	19%	7%	6%	1%	1%	54%
All Non-PPS Students (1,466)	11%	15%	24%	9%	4%	2%	2%	36%

Source: PPS Research, Assessment & Accountability, October 2024

Demographic information for non-resident students is provided for context only as state law prevents school districts from considering race, home language, economic status, disability or other factors when deciding standard inter-district transfers.

PPS schools with the highest number of non-resident students include charter schools (exempt from the standard inter-district transfer process), high schools with boundaries close to bordering districts, and language immersion programs.

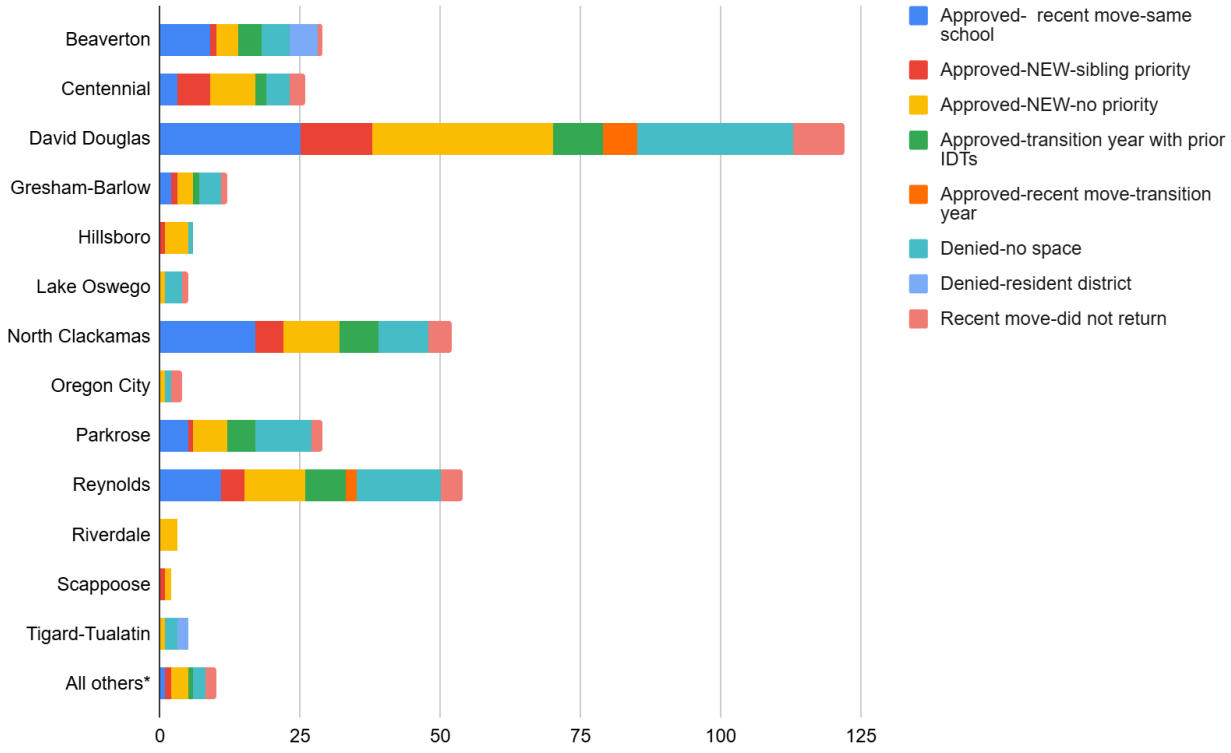
Table 3: 2024-25 Schools and programs with the most students who live in other districts		
School or program	**Students living in other districts**	**Percent of total school or program enrollment**
Kelly - Russian Immersion	96	69%
McDaniel HS - all programs	86	5%
Portland Village School Charter	79	19%
Arthur Academy	74	46%
Franklin HS - all programs	69	4%
Benson HS	66	7%
Lincoln - all programs	54	3%
Kairos PDX Charter	51	23%
Kellogg - all programs	32	5%
Rose City Pk-Vietnamese Immersion	31	15%

The data above pertains to all PPS students who live in other districts, while the charts below describe the outcome of standard inter-district transfer requests for the 2024-25 school year.

Standard Inter-district Transfers

To date, Enrollment and Transfer staff have processed 359 standard inter-district transfer requests into PPS for the 2024-25 school year, and 155 standard transfers out of PPS to other districts. David Douglas remained the district with the most students applying both in and out of PPS. See the attached table for a comparison of recent years by district.

Chart 1: 2024-25 Standard Inter-district transfer applications INTO PPS



Compared to the prior year, the rate of new, non-resident applicants into PPS schools fell by 23%. Additionally the rate of denials into PPS schools due to space limitations increased from 62 in 2023-24 to 84 in 2024-25. As a result of these and other factors, the number of new students approved to transfer into PPS from other districts declined in 2024-25.

Table 4: Comparison of Transfer requests INTO PPS: 2023-24 vs 2024-25

	Approved-recent move	Approved-sibling	Approved-space available	Approved-transition year	**Total Approved**	Denied-no space	Denied-by resident district	Recent move-did not return	**Total Applicants**
2024-25	**73**	**34**	**88**	**44**	**239**	**84**	**7**	**29**	**359**
2023-24	**134**	**33**	**78**	**68**	**313**	**62**	**20**	**48**	**443**
Difference	**(61)**	**1**	**10**	**(24)**	**(74)**	**22**	**(13)**	**(19)**	**(84)**

Meanwhile, standard inter-district transfers out of PPS remained very similar to the prior year, with 96 students receiving transfers through this process while 58 were denied transfers.

Chart 2: 2023-24 Standard Inter-district transfer applications OUT of PPS

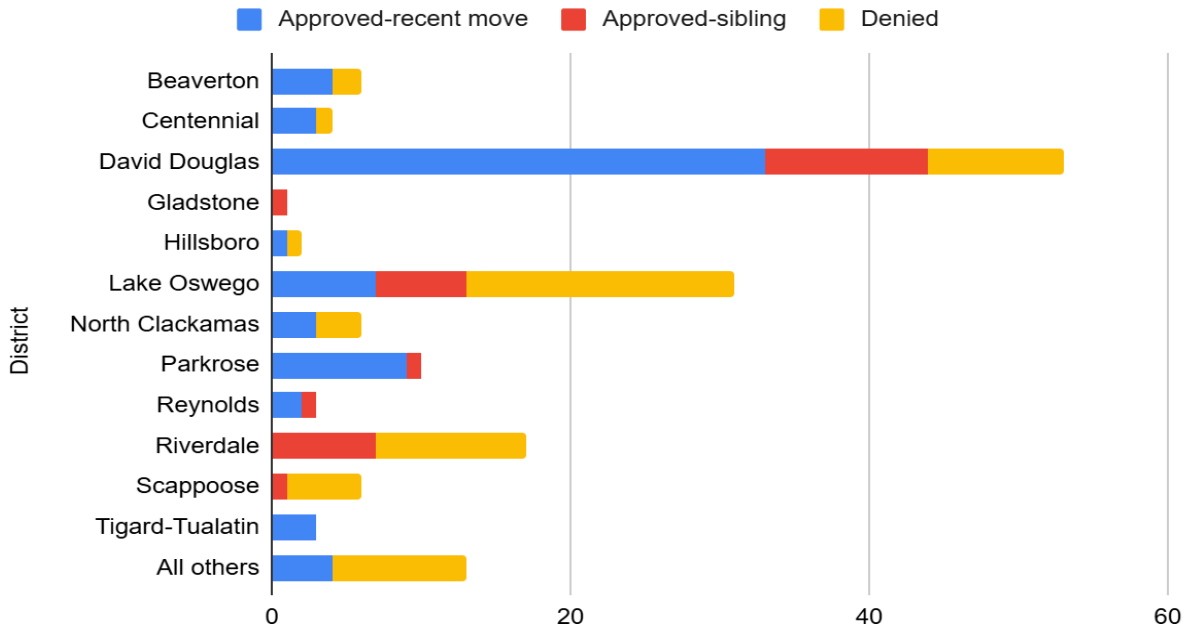


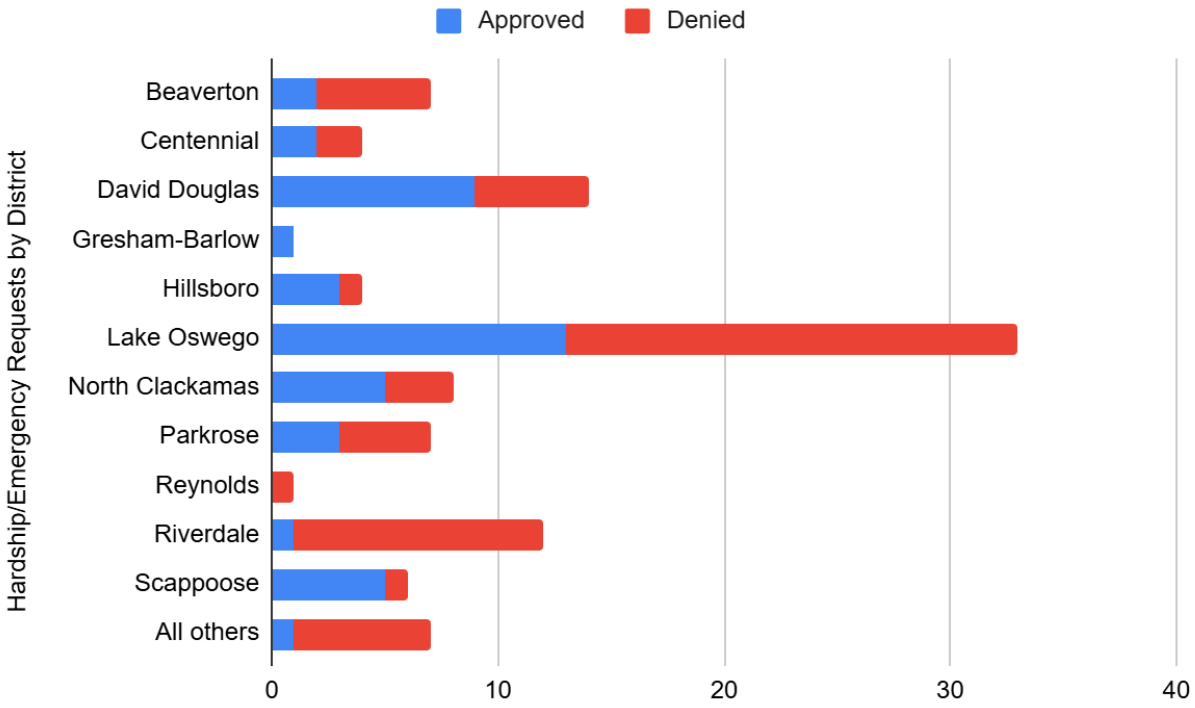
Table 5: Comparison of Transfer requests OUT of PPS: 2023-24 vs 2024-25

	Approved-recent move	Approved-sibling	**Total Approved**	Denied-did not meet criteria	**Total Applicants**
2024-25	**69**	**28**	**97**	**58**	**154**
2023-24	**67**	**29**	**96**	**43**	**139**
Difference	**2**	**(1)**	**1**	**(15)**	**(15)**

Emergency/Hardship Inter-District Transfers Out of PPS

The Emergency/Hardship Inter-district process provides a way for families who do not meet the standard process criteria to request transfer to a different district. At least two staff from Enrollment and Transfer and a Senior Director of Schools reviews each Emergency/Hardship request. The Oregon Department of Education's criteria for emergency/hardship transfers is very narrow and many requests are denied, particularly if parents initiate transfers to other districts without first trying their neighborhood school or other PPS options.

Chart 3: Emergency/Hardship Transfer Applications OUT of PPS



We recently learned of a small residential development straddling the Beaverton School District (BSD)/PPS district line. The county line was changed several years ago to incorporate all 25 homes into Washington County but twelve of the homes remain within the PPS boundary. Adding bus routes to serve these homes would be very costly, so we are working with County and BSD staff on a district boundary change. In the meantime, we intend to utilize the emergency/hardship IDT process to transfer students from homes currently in the PPS portion of the development into BSD.

Right to Return Inter-District Transfers Into PPS

Right to Return is an enrollment opportunity intended to address some of the harmful impacts of gentrification and urban renewal practices in North/Northeast Portland. Families who were displaced from North/Northeast Portland neighborhoods and now live in the David Douglas, Parkrose or Reynolds school districts can transfer through a single application and enroll in one of nineteen North/Northeast PPS schools, based on space availability. Once enrolled, students may remain through the highest grade and then move with their cohorts to the neighborhood schools serving the next level.

The program was called for by African-American community leaders and is generally based upon the City of Portland's North/Northeast housing priority. David Douglas, Parkrose and Reynolds signed onto the agreement in early 2023, and the Right to Return application and website was launched in April 2023. The information was shared with partner districts, schools located in the Right to Return zone and community partners.

PPS received 24 Right to Return applications for the 2023-24 school year. 23 were approved and one student was denied due to space limitations at the requested school. For the 2024-25 school year, PPS received six applications; four were approved and two were denied due to lack of space.

Table 6: Status of Right to Return (RTR) Transfers 2023-24 through 2024-25

Approved RFR School	Continuing RTR	Continuing-moved back to PPS	Attending different PPS school	Unenrolled	Graduated	Total
Boise-Eliot/Humboldt ES	2					**2**
Dr ML King Jr ES	2	2		2		**6**
Irvington ES	1					**1**
Faubion K-8	2					**2**
Vernon K-8	2					**2**
Harriet Tubman MS		1		1		**2**
Grant HS			1			**1**
Jefferson HS	4		1		1	**6**
McDaniel HS	2			1		**3**
Roosevelt HS	1		1			**2**
Total	**16**	**3**	**3**	**4**	**1**	**27**

The table below shows the distribution of Right to Return approvals by home district and student race/ethnicity.

Table 7: Right to Return Students 2023-24 through 2024-25 by Home District and Race

	Student Race			
Home District	**Black**	**Hispanic**	**Multiracial**	**White**
David Douglas	5	3	1	
Parkrose	8	1	1	1
Reynolds	3	1	3	
Total	**16**	**5**	**5**	**1**

FISCAL IMPACT

State school funds are transferred into or out of PPS for students approved through the standard inter-district transfer process.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Families who have moved out of PPS within the past twelve months will receive customized transfer information through email and/or regular mail and phone calls, including links to applications and contact information for their new home districts. Information is posted on the Enrollment and Transfer website, and the application is available online in five supported languages. Lists of students who need to obtain inter-district transfers in order to remain in PPS schools are shared with principals, secretaries, and counselors so they can help inform families through the application process.

TIMELINE FOR IMPLEMENTATION/EVALUATION

April 8:	PPS Board of Education Standard Inter-District Transfer vote
April 15:	Inter-District transfer applications available
May 17:	Deadline for early notice applications
May 30:	Early notice results provided to districts with May 31 deadlines
June 1-Sept 15:	Rolling decisions and notices continue

BOARD OPTIONS WITH ANALYSIS

The Board could choose to expand or eliminate any of the categories listed in the staff recommendation, including adding or deleting transfers for students who have not experienced recent moves or who are siblings of enrolled students.

STAFF RECOMMENDATION

Staff recommends continuation of the following standard inter-district transfer priorities for School Year 2025-26:

Transfer priority for applications INTO PPS	Details
Students enrolled in PPS who move to a different district and wish to remain in their current school	● No limit ● Not subject to space availability ● Effective through the highest grade of the current school
Siblings of students enrolled in PPS in 2024-25, who will remain enrolled in 2025-26	● No limit ● Subject to space availability ● Effective through the highest grade of the new school
Students who live in other districts, are completing their highest grade in a PPS school this year, and apply for the next school level	● No limit ● Subject to space availability ● Effective through the highest grade of the new school
New students who do not qualify for above priorities	● Limited to 100 approvals into all schools ● Subject to space availability ● Effective through the highest grade of the new school
Transfer priority for applications OUT OF PPS	**Details**
Students who moved to a PPS address within the past twelve months and wish to remain in their current district	● No limit ● Transfers good through 12th grade (state law)
Siblings of students enrolled in the requested district in 2024-25, who will remain enrolled in 2025-26.	● No limit ● Transfers good through 12th grade (state law)

I have reviewed this staff report and concur with the recommendation to the Board.

Dr. Kimberlee Armstrong
Superintendent
Portland Public Schools

Attachment:

Resolution
Standard IDT chart
Right to Return Year Two Report (DRAFT)